Practice workbook · Observations and case studies

Observation as a method and in-depth case studies of individuals.

6 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 5 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-RM-07

1. Question 6 · part whole · 12 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 02

Worked-example retry · Attempt part whole only.

***6** Rosenhan (1973) studied the way in which patients were treated in mental health hospitals. Eight confederate observers were able to get themselves admitted to different psychiatric wards in different hospitals using fake symptoms of mental health. They then conducted participant observations on the hospital wards.

The confederate observers took part in the daily activities on the ward to fit in with the actual patient routines. They also watched how the staff interacted with patients, making detailed notes in diaries of the events they observed. These notes included examples about patient behaviours that had been misinterpreted by the staff. They also recorded how little time the nurses and doctors spent on the ward interacting with patients.

None of the staff or patients on the wards were aware that the observations were taking place. When the confederate observers were taking notes and writing in their diaries in public, their behaviour was interpreted as part of their mental health condition. Only the other patients on the ward showed any suspicion about the notes being taken by the confederate observers.

Evaluate the use of an observation to investigate human behaviour.

(12)

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1. Question 6 · part whole · 12 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 02

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1. Question 6 · part whole · 12 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 02

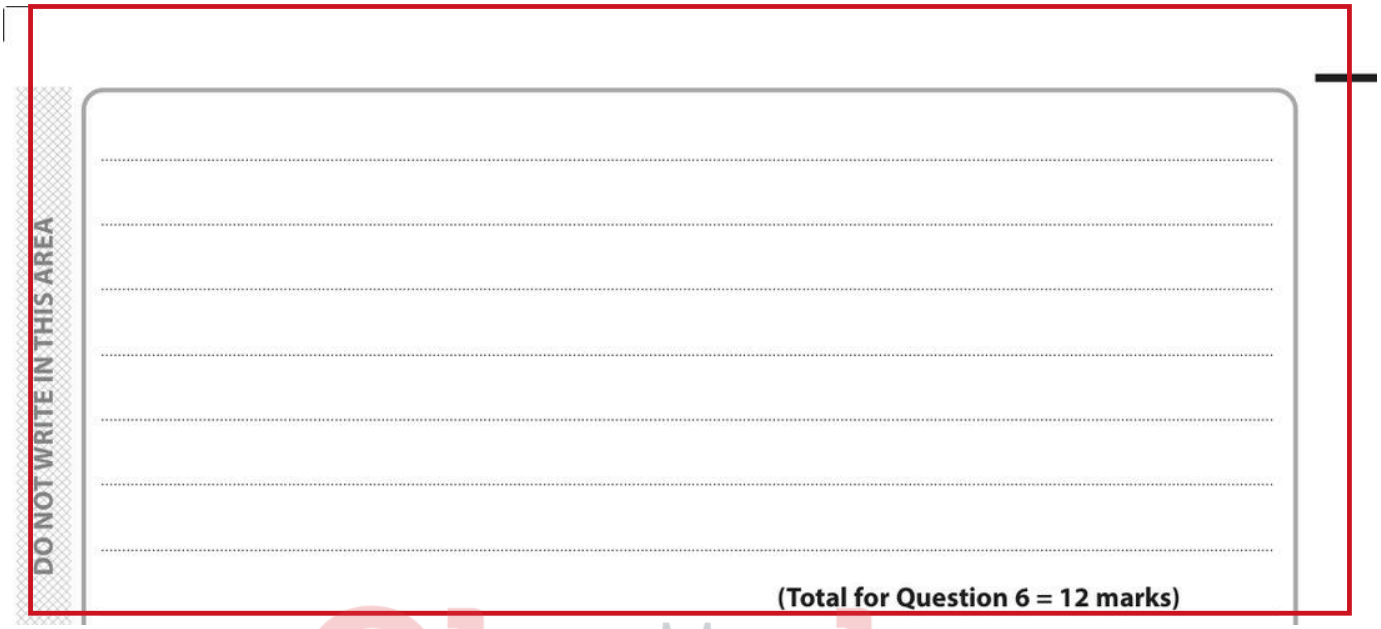
Worked-example retry · Attempt part whole only.



1. Question 6 · part whole · 12 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 02

Worked-example retry · Attempt part whole only.



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1. Question 6 · part whole · 12 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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2. Question 7 · part whole · 12 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

***7** Ainsworth et al. (1978) investigated the emotional bond of attachment. They conducted structured observations of infant responses to their mother and a stranger.

A room was designed for the infant and mother to use, which contained toys for the infant to play with during the observation.

Each mother was aware that they were taking part in an eight-phase standardised procedure during the observation. The behaviour of the infant was written down during each of these eight phases without the infant knowing.

An example of the type of behaviour recorded was whether the infant was distressed when the mother left the infant alone with a stranger.

Evaluate the use of the observation research method to investigate human behaviour.

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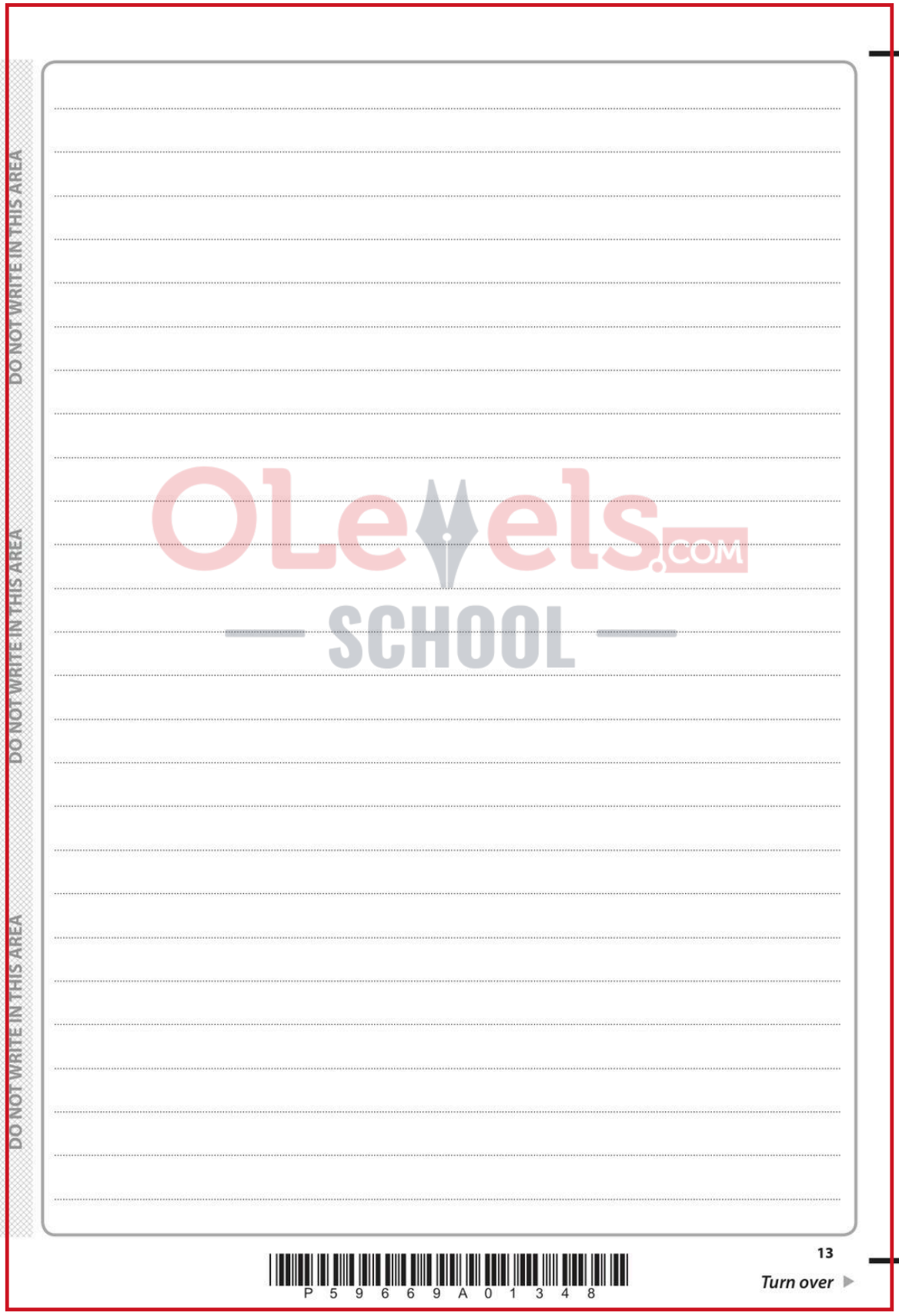
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2. Question 7 · part whole · 12 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



2. Question 7 · part whole · 12 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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(Total for Question 7 = 12 marks)

2. Question 7 · part whole · 12 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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3. Question 5 · part whole · 12 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

***5** H.M. underwent an experimental brain operation in 1953 where doctors removed most of his hippocampus and amygdala. It became clear that as a result of the operation H.M. had an impaired long-term memory, but his short-term memory and some other skills were largely intact.

H.M. was studied from the day of his operation until he died in 2008. He took part in experimental tasks, some of these he repeated regularly. H.M. was observed by multiple researchers over his lifetime, and his amnesia was compared to that of other amnesiac patients to see if memory loss was similar.

His case provided psychologists with a range of information about memory processes that may otherwise not have been understood.

Evaluate the use of case studies to investigate human behaviour.

(12)

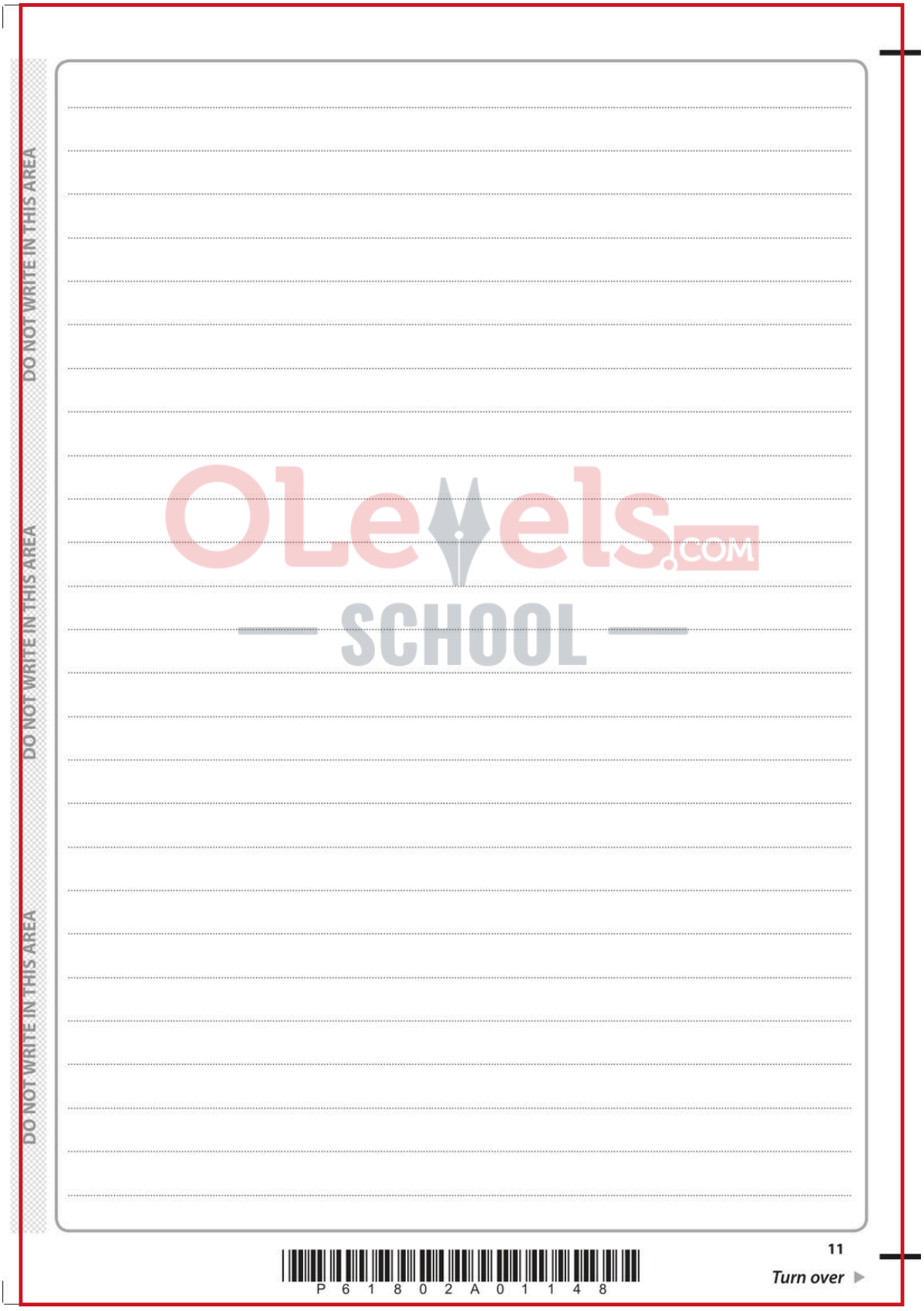
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3. Question 5 · part whole · 12 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



3. Question 5 · part whole · 12 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 02

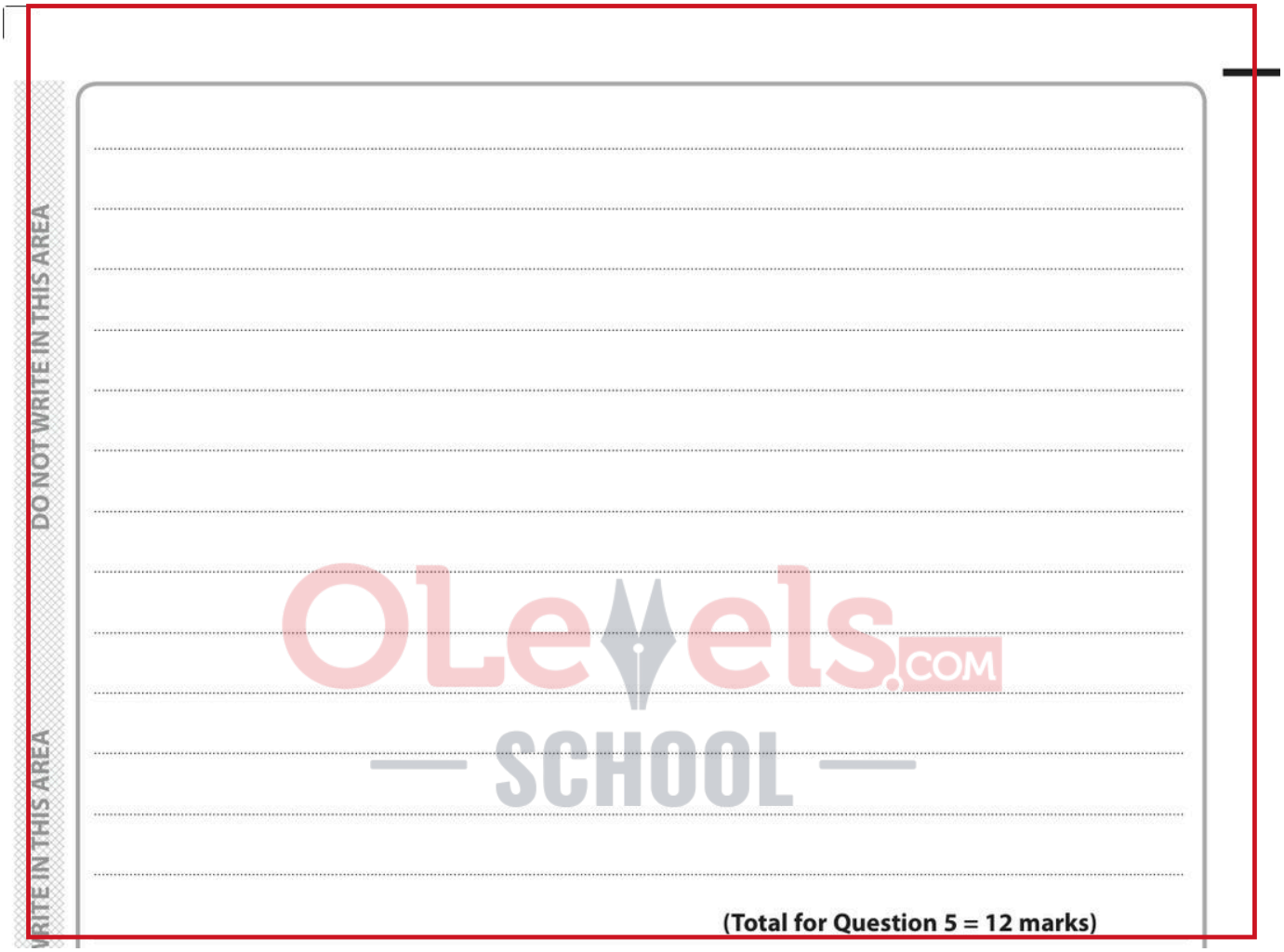
Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



3. Question 5 · part whole · 12 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



3. Question 5 · part whole · 12 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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4. Question 2 · part a · 1 mark

2021 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

2 Yolanda is conducting an observation of children's play in an early years day care setting. She observed children in the setting for four hours on a Monday.

(a) Define what is meant by an 'observation'.

(1)

(b) Describe how Yolanda could have used an opportunity sampling technique to select the children for her observation.

(2)

(c) Yolanda recorded the number of children who played with the different types of toys in the day care setting.

There were a total of 74 children recorded:

- 23 of the total children played with vehicles
- 11 of the total children played with dolls
- 29 of the total children played with role-play toys.

The remaining children played with arts and crafts toys.

(i) Calculate the ratio of children who played with dolls to those who played with arts and crafts toys.

(2)

Ratio .....

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4. Question 2 · part a · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

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5. Question 2 · part a · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

2 Kamira is investigating morality. She wants to find out how likely people are to return lost items. Kamira conducted an observation for her investigation.

Kamira went to a large shopping centre and positioned herself in the food court where people often sit to eat and have been known to leave personal items behind when leaving.

When someone had left an item behind, Kamira observed the behaviour of all passers-by who saw the item. She recorded whether they:

- looked at the item, but then ignored it
- picked up the item and gave it to a member of staff
- walked away with the item.

(a) Describe why Kamira may have used an observation research method for her investigation.

(2)

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5. Question 2 · part a · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

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(b) Draw a frequency table that Kamira could have used to record the data for her observation.

You must include appropriate column and row headings.

(3)

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(c) Describe **one** situational variable that Kamira may have considered when conducting her observation.

(2)

(Total for Question 2 = 7 marks)

5. Question 2 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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6. Question 5 · part a · 1 mark

2024 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

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5 Rocio conducted a case study on her patient who had an addiction to alcohol. She worked with the patient for six months to help treat their addiction.

(a) Define what is meant by a 'case study'.

(1)

(b) Rocio recorded the conversations with the patient as part of her case study. She also monitored the alcohol consumption of the patient in units of alcohol (one unit of alcohol = 10 ml).

Her results are shown in **Table 2**.

Month	Total alcohol consumption in units
March	298
April	221
May	181
June	140
July	99
August	59

Table 2

Describe, using an example from Rocio's case study, what is meant by 'quantitative data'.

(2)

6. Question 5 · part a · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

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